



TIPS & TRICKS

Add colour to Linux man pages in Debian or Ubuntu based Linux distributions

First, install a small program called 'most' using the following command:

```
$sudo apt-get install most
$export MANPAGER="/usr/bin/most"
```

If it does not work, try:

```
$export MANPAGER="/usr/local/bin/most"
```

That's it. Now try running the manual page. It will be displayed in colour.

—Jestin Joy, jestinjoy@gmail.com

Create a pop-up window by typing a command

We can create a pop-up window by typing a command. This is a great help to display messages from scripts onto the GUI window. To create the pop-up window, you can use the 'xmessage' command. Open the 'Terminal' and type the following:

```
xmessage -default button "This is to Test"
```

This will create a pop-up window with a default button and 'This is to Test' will appear as text on this window.

For further information, refer to the man pages of 'xmessage'.

—Vipul Vaid, vipul.vid@gmail.com

Formatting a pen drive in Ubuntu

Here is a simple way to format a pen drive if you are working on the Ubuntu operating system.

Step 1: Open Terminal and type

```
#fdisk -l
```

The output will be somewhat as shown below:

```
Disk /dev/sda: 320.1 GB, 320072933376 bytes
255 heads, 63 sectors/track, 38913 cylinders
Units = cylinders of 16065 * 512 = 8225280 bytes
Disk identifier: 0xa497a497
```

Device	Boot	Start	End	Blocks	Id	System
/dev/sda1	*	1	6374	51199123+	7	HPFS/NTFS
/dev/sda2		19123	38913	158971207+	7	HPFS/NTFS
/dev/sda3		6375	19110	102381920	f	W95 Ext'd (LBA)
/dev/sda5		6375	13862	60141644+	7	HPFS/NTFS
/dev/sda6		13862	15936	16665957+	7	HPFS/NTFS
/dev/sda7		15937	16318	3068383+	83	Linux
/dev/sda8		16319	18636	18619303+	83	Linux
/dev/sda9		18637	19110	3807373+	82	Linux
swap / Solaris						

Partition table entries are not in disk order

```
Disk /dev/sdb: 2063 MB, 2063597568 bytes
64 heads, 62 sectors/track, 1015 cylinders
Units = cylinders of 3968 * 512 = 2031616 bytes
Disk identifier: 0x00000000
```

Device	Boot	Start	End	Blocks	Id	System
/dev/sdb1	*	1	1015	2013729	b	W95 FAT32

Step 2: Now, identify your USB drive from the output of the above command, and run the following command:

```
#sudo mkfs.vfat /dev/sdxx
```

...where '/dev/sdxx' is the path of the USB device to be formatted.

—Yogesh Kamble, yogesh605@yahoo.com